25900348

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025

Third SEMESTER

Scheme

Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG3DSEECO204 - NAVIGATING SURVEYS FOR ACADEMIC AND PROFESSIONAL SUCCESS

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours

Maximum Marks: 70

Remember (K), Understand (U), Apply(A), Analyse (An), Evaluate(E), Create (C), Skill (S), Interest (I) and Appreciation (Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Multiple Choice Question
Answer all questions
Each question carries **1** marks

1. c) Experimental research
2. c) Simple random sampling
3. b) Cartogram
4. b) A tool to summarize, analyze, and reorganize data
5. a) Past events and their interpretation
6. b) Systematic collection of data from a sample or population
7. c) Conceptual frameworks are built around specific variables and their relationships
8. b) Pie chart
9. c) To ensure data collected is relevant and valid
10. b) Testing questions before main study

[1x10 = 10]

Part B

Short Answer
Answer any **10** questions
Each question carries **3** marks

11. **Limitation of Diagnostic Research**
    Diagnostic research identifies causes of problems but fails to isolate multiple interacting factors in complex social issues like poverty (1). It becomes descriptive rather than causal (1). Hence, findings lack precision and general applicability (1).
12. **Methods of Collecting Primary Data**
    Primary data are obtained through (i) interviews: personal or telephonic (1), (ii) observation: participant/non-participant (1), and (iii) questionnaires or experiments (1).
13. **Reliability in Research**
    Reliability means the consistency or stability of measurement results over repeated trials. A reliable tool gives similar results under similar conditions. It is ensured by test–retest and internal consistency methods. Definition-2; method/example-1
14. **Selecting a Research Topic**
    A researcher identifies an area of interest (1), reviews literature and checks feasibility (1), and ensures significance or practical relevance before finalizing the topic (1).
15. **Coding for Income Groups**
    Coding assigns numerical symbols to data categories. Example: 1 = Low, 2 = Middle, 3 = High income. It simplifies data entry and analysis. (3)
16. **Reliability through Proper Survey Steps**
    Proper survey design ensures reliable data through clear objectives and appropriate sampling, pretesting and unbiased questions and training or standardized data collection procedures. 3 points-3
17. **Quota Sampling**
    Quota sampling divides the population into subgroups such as gender or age. Respondents are chosen non-randomly until each quota is filled. It ensures representation but not randomness. Definition-2; Example-1
18. **Histogram vs Frequency Polygon**
    Histogram uses adjacent bars to represent frequency of continuous data. Frequency polygon joins midpoints of class intervals with straight lines. Both show frequency distribution but differ in form. 2 differences- 1.5x2=3
19. **Descriptive vs Inferential Analysis**
    Descriptive analysis summarizes data using averages and charts. Inferential analysis draws conclusions about a population from a sample. The former describes, the latter generalises. 2 differences- 1.5x2=3
20. **Primary vs Secondary Data**
    Primary data are collected first-hand by the researcher. Secondary data are already existing data collected by others. Primary data are accurate but costly; secondary are cheaper but may be outdated. Definitions-2; Examples-1
21. **Census vs Sample Method**
    Census covers the whole population for accuracy. Sampling studies a representative

portion for economy and speed. Census avoids sampling error but is costly and time-consuming. 2differences- 1.5x2=3

22. **General vs Specific Objectives**
    General objectives express the overall aim of the study. Specific objectives break it into measurable parts guiding data collection. Both must align with the research problem. 2differences- 1.5x2=3
23. **Frequency Table**
    A frequency table shows data values or class intervals and their corresponding frequencies. It organizes raw data systematically and helps prepare graphs or diagrams. 3
24. **Purpose of Scientific Inquiry**
    Scientific inquiry seeks objective, verifiable knowledge about phenomena. It follows systematic observation and testing. It aims to explain, predict, and control occurrences. 3
25. **Operational Definition**
    An operational definition states how a concept or variable is measured or observed. Example: defining poverty as income below ₹10,000/month. It ensures clarity, replication, and objectivity. Definition-3

Part C

Short Essay
Answer any **5** questions
Each question carries **6** marks

26. Analyse how case study and field study methods are applied in social and economic research. [An] / [CO2]

    Case study and field study methods are applied in social and economic research to gain deep, contextual insights into real-life situations, behaviours, and systems. They help researchers understand complex phenomena by observing and analyzing specific cases or environments directly.

    Case studies focus on a single unit (e.g., person, community, institution) to explore its dynamics in depth. They are useful for examining unique or deviant cases, policy impacts, or social processes.

    Field studies involve direct observation and interaction in natural settings, allowing researchers to collect firsthand data on social and economic activities, cultural practices, or community responses.

    Both methods emphasize qualitative analysis, though they can incorporate quantitative data, and are valuable for generating hypotheses, informing policy, and understanding lived experiences.
27. Why is randomness important in cluster sampling?
    [K] / [CO1, CO2, CO3, CO4, CO5, CO6]

    Randomness is crucial in cluster sampling to ensure unbiased representation of the population. It ensures unbiased representation and improves generalizability of results.

- **Reduces selection bias**: Randomly selecting clusters prevents researchers from choosing groups that may skew results.
- **Improves generalizability**: It helps ensure that findings from the sample can be applied to the broader population.
- **Maintains statistical validity**: Random selection supports the use of probability theory for estimating sampling errors and confidence intervals.
- **Enhances diversity**: Random clusters are more likely to capture varied characteristics across the population.

28. Discuss the essential qualities of a good interviewer. [U] / [CO4]

    Essential characteristics of a good interviewer consist of a deep understanding of the topic, ability to recognize the uniqueness, plan the interview carefully, thorough research of the candidate, effective communication skills, asking the right questions, control of anger and aggression, expertise in reading body language**.**

29. Evaluate the usefulness of reports in organizational decision-making.

    [E] / [CO1, CO2, CO3, CO4, CO5, CO6]

    Annual reports, quarterly reviews, and strategic assessments help organizations understand where they stand today and where they need to go tomorrow**.** These documents identify strengths to leverage, weaknesses to address, opportunities to pursue, and threats to mitigate.

30. Explain participatory observation with examples. [U] / [CO4]

    It is a research method that includes observing the behaviors, interactions, and practices of the participants, formal and informal interviewing and the collection of documentary data such as photographs and diaries. Eg. Workplace Observation, Religious Festivals, Homeless Community.

31. Discuss with examples how applied research helps in solving real-world social and economic problems [An] / [CO1]

    Applied research has an important role to play in solving real-world problems. This is because it enables researchers to combine creativity and knowledge in order to find solutions for social and economic problems. Applied research is the process of developing and implementing solutions for real-world problems. Examples of applied research include improving educational practices, creating new medical treatments, and finding innovative technology.

32. Explain the role of a literature review in the conceptual phase of a research design

    [U] / [CO1, CO2, CO3, CO4, CO5, CO6]

    A literature review justifies the choice of research design, methods, and instruments**.** It helps researchers explain why certain approaches were selected over others and how their study contributes to filling gaps or addressing limitations in the existing literature. Therefore literature review plays a crucial role in the conceptual phase of a research design by providing the foundational knowledge and context needed to formulate a viable

and impactful study. It's not just a summary of existing works; it's a critical analysis that helps to shape the entire research project.

33. Discuss the objectives of editing. [U] / [CO5]

    The objectives of editing include clarifying responses, addressing omissions, avoiding bias, making judgments to complete incomplete answers, resolving handwriting issues, and recontacting respondents if needed for clarification.

34. Describe the different types of social and economic surveys with suitable examples.

    [U] / [CO2]

    Social survey is a research method used to collect information in a standardised way from large numbers of people. Surveys are designed to produce quantitative data that can be easily compared, analysed, and generalised to wider populations. Example: Homework Survey, Youth lifestyle survey. Different types of surveys- Descriptive Surveys, Cross-Sectional Surveys, Analytical Surveys, Exploratory Surveys, etc. Surveys are often designed to gather specific information on economic activities, preferences, behaviours, and attitudes. Examples of economic surveys include household income and expenditure surveys, business confidence surveys, consumer sentiment surveys, and government economic surveys**.** Economic surveys include household income and expenditure surveys, business confidence surveys, consumer sentiment surveys, and government economic surveys**.**

35. Why is it necessary to state the significance of a research study?

    [An] / [CO1, CO2, CO3, CO4, CO5, CO6]

    It shows the relevance of the study, justifies the effort, and highlights its contribution to solving problems or filling gaps in knowledge.

[6x5 = 30]